node in Ethereum? This move requires standing up the Ethereum nodes, securing them as specified in the Ethereum protocol, and managing the accounts and the requirements of the protocol. It typically is not the responsibility of an individual developer to set up and manage blockchain nodes. Consider this: Do you run an email server yourself to interact with your email client? No. Your IT department does that for you. That is precisely the role played by Infura: *it is a secure, production-ready, scalable infrastructure to support your blockchain nodes* in place of your prototype local environment. It provides the nodes and API to access Ethereum networks. Let's learn to use the nodes and networks offered by Infura.

8.2 Infura blockchain infrastructure

Figure 8.2 provides an overview of the various services offered by Infura in support of the expanding ecosystem of blockchain-based Dapps. In the bottom-left corner is the familiar Ganache that you used as a test node for the Dapps in earlier chapters--your blockchain development on training wheels. You can take the training wheels off with Infura. Most of figure 8.2 is about services offered by the Infura infrastructure, the primary function of which is to provision Ethereum blockchain nodes. It also makes available the endpoints and the API to connect to the nodes. A public network connects these nodes. You'll use the Ropsten network, as shown in figure 8.1. Infura also provides other